

Garmin & Coros Watches for Ironman — AU Prices

Software & experience: Garmin vs Coros for a female Ironman athlete

Garmin

- **Interface:** touchscreen + 5 buttons on the AMOLED models; highly customisable data screens, watch faces and Connect IQ apps.
- **Triathlon:** mature multisport/triathlon profiles with transitions, open-water swim, and the widest bike-sensor support (power meters, Edge bike computers, Varia radar).
- **Coaching:** Training Readiness, HRV status, recovery time and daily suggested workouts on the watch; syncs with TrainingPeaks.
- **Women's health:** long-established menstrual cycle and pregnancy tracking in Garmin Connect, with phase-based training tips.
- **Everyday:** Garmin Pay, richer notifications; app can feel busy.

Coros

- **Interface:** touchscreen + digital crown on both the Pace 4 and Apex 4, plus a mic for voice notes; simple and fast, but fewer customisation options than Garmin.
- **Triathlon:** solid triathlon mode with transitions and open-water swim; fewer bike-sensor features than Garmin.
- **Coaching:** free Training Hub web platform with strong load/fatigue analytics and structured workouts; syncs with TrainingPeaks.
- **Women's health:** menstrual cycle tracking added Oct 2025 – predictions on the training calendar, watch reminders on every Coros model listed.
- **Everyday:** no payments, basic smart features; much longer battery for the money.

For Ironman racing: plan for up to the 17-hour cut-off. The **Forerunner 265S** manages 15 h in multi-band mode, so race it in SatIQ (18 h) or GPS-only (24 h). The **Epix Pro 42mm** manages 13 h multi-band, so race it in all-systems (21 h) or GPS-only (28 h). The **Pace 4** (31 h dual-frequency) and **Apex 4 42mm** (41 h full GPS) cover a full race with room to spare. For comfort over a long day, the Pace 4 (32–40 g) and 265S (39 g) are lightest; the Apex 4 42mm (~56 g) and Epix Pro 42mm (58–63 g) are heavier but still compact. **Picks:** Pace 4 for best value (~\$430 on Amazon); Forerunner 265S if she prefers Garmin's ecosystem (~\$572 at Kogan); Apex 4 42mm for maps and the longest battery (~\$760); Epix Pro 42mm for a premium AMOLED with maps and a flashlight (~\$1,699 Sapphire at JB).

The Garmins are last-gen (since replaced); the Coros Pace 4 and Apex 4 are current models (as of Oct 2026). Prices are the most recent AU listings found via price-comparison sites; retailer sites could not be checked directly, so confirm before buying. "Not listed" means no current listing was found.

Model	Price (AUD)	Pros	Cons	Sensors
Garmin Epix Pro (Gen 2) 42mm 2023 · replaced by Fenix 8 AMOLED View photo	Kogan: Not listed JB Hi-Fi: Sapphire: \$1,699 (Aug 2026) Amazon AU: No 42mm price found	• AMOLED + built-in LED flashlight • 42mm, 58–63g – suits smaller wrists • Full maps, multi-band GPS • Premium steel/titanium build • Same training features as Fenix 7 Pro	• Battery tight: 13h multi-band, 21h all-systems • No speaker/mic, no dive depth sensor • Buttons not leak-proof • Hard to find – only AU price found is \$1,699 (Sapphire)	HR: Elevate Gen 5 optical ECG: Hardware capable; app not approved for this model in AU (2025) SpO2: Yes GNSS: Multi-band (SatIQ) Alt/Compass/Gyro: Yes / Yes / Yes Thermometer: Yes Extra: Ambient light, LED flashlight
Garmin Forerunner 265S (42mm) 2023 · replaced by Forerunner 570 (2025) View photo	Kogan: \$572 (Aug 2026) JB Hi-Fi: \$499 sale, Pink (was \$799, undated) Amazon AU: \$758.84 (Aug 2026)	• Light (39g), 42mm – suits smaller wrists • AMOLED touchscreen + 5 buttons • Multi-band GPS; Training Readiness, HRV status • Onboard music, Garmin Pay • Cheapest Garmin here	• Only 15h in multi-band GPS – tight for a long Ironman • No maps (breadcrumb only) • No flashlight, speaker or ECG • Superseded by Forerunner 570	HR: Elevate Gen 4 optical ECG: No SpO2: Yes GNSS: Multi-band (SatIQ) Alt/Compass/Gyro: Yes / Yes / Yes Thermometer: Yes Extra: Ambient light

Model	Price (AUD)	Pros	Cons	Sensors
Coros Pace 4 Nov 2025 · current model View photo	Kogan: Not listed JB Hi-Fi: Not stocked (JB doesn't carry Coros) Amazon AU: \$430.10	• Ultralight (32–40g) • Bright AMOLED touchscreen + crown • 41h GPS / 31h dual-frequency • Mic for voice notes and commands • Cheapest watch here (~\$430)	• Wrist HR can miss short, sharp spikes – use a chest strap for intervals • Full maps unconfirmed – may be breadcrumb only • No contactless payments • Smaller app ecosystem than Garmin	HR: Coros optical (revised) ECG: Electrode reported (HRV); not verified SpO2: Yes GNSS: Dual-frequency Alt/Compass/Gyro: Yes / Yes / Yes Thermometer: Yes Extra: Microphone
Coros Apex 4 (42mm) Oct 2025 · current model View photo	Kogan: Not listed JB Hi-Fi: Not stocked (JB doesn't carry Coros) Amazon AU: \$760.32 (white; black \$779.95)	• Sapphire glass + titanium bezel, ~56g • 41h full GPS – covers any Ironman • Global offline maps, turn-by-turn • Touchscreen, mic + speaker (voice pins) • ~24 days in daily use	• MIP display – dull next to AMOLED • ~\$330 more than the Pace 4 for similar training features • No contactless payments • Limited AU stock	HR: Coros optical ECG: Not listed SpO2: Yes GNSS: Dual-frequency Alt/Compass/Gyro: Yes (dual-range baro) / Yes / Yes Thermometer: Not listed Extra: Mic + speaker

Photos: this environment blocks image downloads, so each model links to a photo search instead. Prices gathered 9 Oct 2026 from search snapshots; dates show when a price was last seen where known (Amazon snapshot dates unknown). Amazon prices link to the listing. Coros "ECG" electrodes are used for HRV readings, not medical AFib detection.